scōp



FOR SCŌP SUBSCRIBERS

The Scōp 8 week plan

Three runs and three workouts a week. One version for the gym, one for your living room. A first 5K or a faster one.

HOME GYM FIRST 5K RUNNER

START HERE

How the plan works

Six sessions a week for eight weeks: three runs, three workouts and a rest day. Pick one workout track and one running track. Mix them however suits you.

HOME

Workouts at home

Newer to training, or no gym? Bodyweight only, about 25 minutes, and all you need is a bit of floor and a sturdy chair.

GYM

Workouts in the gym

Already lifting and have a gym? Strength plus one hybrid conditioning session, about 45 to 50 minutes each.

FIRST 5K

Your first 5K

Starting from little or no running. 30 minute walk and run sessions that build to 30 minutes of running, then your first 5K in week 8.

RUNNER

For runners

Already running 5K comfortably. Intervals, an easy run and a long run, finishing with a 5K time trial.

A typical week

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Run 1	Workout A	Run 2	Workout B	Workout C	Run 3	Rest. It counts.

Move days around to fit your week. Keep one full rest day and avoid putting Run 3 the day after a leg workout.

How hard is "easy"?

Easy
You could hold a full conversation. Slower than you think.

Steady
You can talk in short sentences. Comfortably uncomfortable.

Hard
A few words at a time. Not a sprint, but close.

The rules. Warm up for 5 minutes before every session. Repeat any week you found tough, the plan waits for you. If you miss a session, carry on from the next one rather than doubling up. And take one heaped scoop of Scōp every morning, training day or not.

THE RUNS

Three runs a week

Every run starts with a 5 minute brisk walk and ends with a 5 minute walk to cool down.

FIRST 5K Walk, run, repeat

WEEK	EACH RUN (DO IT 3 TIMES THIS WEEK)	RUNNING	TOTAL
1	Run 1 min, walk 2 min. Repeat 10 times	10 min	30 min
2	Run 2 min, walk 2 min. Repeat 8 times	16 min	32 min
3	Run 3 min, walk 2 min. Repeat 6 times	18 min	30 min
4	Run 4 min, walk 2 min. Repeat 5 times	20 min	30 min
5	Run 8 min, walk 2 min. Repeat 3 times	24 min	30 min
6	Run 10 min, walk 1 min. Repeat 3 times	30 min	33 min
7	Runs 1 and 2: run 15 min, walk 1 min, run 15 min. Run 3: run 25 min without stopping	30 min	31 min
8	Run 1: 30 min without stopping. Run 2: 20 min easy, to keep your legs fresh. Run 3: **your first 5K**. Easy pace, any time counts	5K	5K

Every session is around 30 minutes from week 1, so your legs are used to being out for as long as a first 5K usually takes.

RUNNER Faster, further

WEEK	RUN 1: INTERVALS	RUN 2: EASY	RUN 3: LONG
1	6 × 2 min hard, 2 min easy jog	30 min easy	45 min easy
2	6 × 3 min hard, 2 min easy jog	30 min easy	50 min easy
3	5 × 4 min hard, 2 min easy jog	35 min easy	55 min easy
4	8 × 1 min fast, 1 min easy jog. Lighter week	30 min easy	45 min easy
5	4 × 5 min hard, 2 min easy jog	35 min easy	60 min easy
6	20 min steady, no stopping	40 min easy	65 min easy
7	6 × 3 min hard, 90 sec easy jog	35 min easy	70 min easy
8	4 × 2 min hard, 2 min easy. Keep it sharp, not tiring	25 min easy	**5K time trial**. A parkrun works well

Can't get through a session? Swap the next one for an easy run and try again the following week.

THE WORKOUTS

HOME Bodyweight at home

About 25 minutes. Rest 60 seconds between sets. Move slowly and with control, the reps only count if they look like the picture in your head.

Workout A · Legs and core

Squat	3 × 10
Reverse lunge	3 × 8 each leg
Glute bridge	3 × 12
Dead bug	3 × 8 each side
Plank	3 × 20 sec

Workout B · Upper and core

Incline press up (hands on a chair)	3 × 8
Superman	3 × 10
Chair dip	3 × 8
Bird dog	3 × 8 each side
Side plank	2 × 20 sec each

Workout C · Full body circuit

Squat	10	Glute bridge	10
Incline press up	8	Mountain climber	10 each leg

Do all four moves back to back, rest 60 seconds, then repeat. Four rounds in total.

Level up every two weeks

WEEKS	WHAT CHANGES
1 to 2	As written above
3 to 4	Add 2 reps to every set and 10 seconds to every plank
5 to 6	Add a fourth set to Workouts A and B. Add a fifth round to Workout C
7 to 8	Harder versions: press ups from the floor (knees or toes), split squats instead of lunges, single leg glute bridges

THE WORKOUTS

GYM Strength and hybrid

About 45 to 50 minutes. Rest 2 minutes between heavy sets and 60 to 90 seconds on the rest. Pick a weight that leaves about two good reps in the tank.

Workout A · Lower

Back squat or goblet squat	4 × 6
Romanian deadlift	3 × 8
Walking lunge	3 × 10 each leg
Calf raise	3 × 12
Plank	3 × 40 sec

Workout B · Upper

Bench press or dumbbell press	4 × 6
Seated or bent over row	4 × 8
Overhead press	3 × 8
Pull up or lat pulldown	3 × 8
Farmer's carry	3 × 30 m

Workout C · Hybrid

Deadlift	4 × 5
Then straight into the conditioning circuit	

Row or ski erg	250 m
Kettlebell swing	12
Wall ball or thruster	10
Burpee	8

Circuit: four rounds, 90 seconds rest between rounds. Note your total time and try to beat it next week.

How to progress

WEEKS	WHAT CHANGES
1 to 3	Hit every rep on every set? Add 2.5 kg next time. Missed reps? Stay at that weight
4	Lighter week. Same exercises, drop one set from each
5 to 7	Keep adding weight. Add a fifth round to the Workout C circuit
8	Finish strong. Work up to a heavy set of 3 on squat, bench and deadlift, with good form

KEEP SCORE

Tick it off

Print it, stick it on the fridge, tick a box after every session. Strangely satisfying.

	RUN 1	WORKOUT A	RUN 2	WORKOUT B	WORKOUT C	RUN 3
Week 1						
Week 2						
Week 3						
Week 4						
Week 5						
Week 6						
Week 7						
Week 8						

WEEK 8 RESULT

My 5K time

My proudest session

THEN WHAT?

Start again from week 1 with heavier weights or faster runs. Or move from Home to Gym, or from First 5K to Runner. Tag **@scopdaily** when you finish. We like hearing about it.

Before you start. If you're new to exercise, have a health condition or injury, or are pregnant, check with your GP first. Stop if you feel pain, dizziness or chest discomfort. Creatine increases performance in repeated bursts of short, high intensity exercise. Food supplements are not a substitute for a varied diet and healthy lifestyle.